

OLYMPISM & OLYMPIC MOVEMENT

Quick Self-Revision Notes • Easy English • Exam Focused

■ EXAM FOCUS

Learn these first: Olympic Values • Ancient vs Modern Olympics • Rings • Motto • Flag • Oath • Anthem • IOC/NOC/IFs

1. Olympism

Meaning: Olympism is a philosophy of life that combines **sport, education and culture**. It aims to develop a person's body, mind and character through sport.

3 Main Olympic Values — E-F-R

- **Excellence:** Always try to do your best and keep improving.
- **Friendship:** Build friendship, understanding and cooperation among people and nations.
- **Respect:** Respect yourself, others, the rules and the spirit of sport.

■ **Must Remember: Excellence + Friendship + Respect are the three core Olympic values.**

2. Olympic Value Education

Olympic education teaches values that can be applied in sports as well as everyday life.

- **Joy of Effort:** Enjoy participation, effort and improvement—not only winning.
- **Fair Play:** Follow rules honestly, avoid cheating and accept results properly.
- **Respect for Others:** Respect teammates, opponents, coaches, officials and differences between people.
- **Pursuit of Excellence:** Set goals, work hard and continuously improve; excellence means giving your best.
- **Balance Among Body, Will & Mind:** Body = fitness/health; Will = determination/self-control; Mind = knowledge/thinking.

■ **Quick Formula: Joy of Effort + Fair Play + Respect + Excellence + Body–Will–Mind Balance**

3. Ancient and Modern Olympics

Ancient Olympics

- Held in **ancient Greece**, at **Olympia**.
- Held in honour of **Zeus**.
- Participation was mainly by Greek athletes.
- Included athletic and combat events.
- The ancient Olympic Games eventually came to an end.

Modern Olympics

- **Pierre de Coubertin** played a major role in reviving the Olympic Games.
- The first modern Olympic Games were held in **1896 at Athens, Greece**.
- Modern Olympics bring athletes from countries around the world together.
- They promote the Olympic ideals of **Excellence, Friendship and Respect**.

■ **Very Important: Ancient → Olympia, Greece, Zeus | Modern → 1896, Athens, Pierre de Coubertin**

Ancient Olympics

Modern Olympics

Ancient Greece; mainly Greek participation	International; athletes from many countries
Held at Olympia	Held in different host cities
Dedicated to Zeus	Based on Olympic ideals and values

4. Olympic Symbols

Olympic Rings: The symbol has **five interlocking rings**: blue, yellow, black, green and red. They represent the unity of the world/continents participating in the Olympic Movement.

Olympic Motto: *Citius. Altius. Fortius – Communiter*

Meaning: **Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together.**

Olympic Flag: White background with the five interlocking Olympic rings. It represents the unity of the Olympic Movement.

Olympic Oath: A promise made during the Olympic Games to respect the rules, show fair play and maintain sportsmanship.

Olympic Anthem: An important Olympic symbol performed during major Olympic ceremonies and representing the Olympic Movement and its ideals.

5. Olympic Movement Structure

IOC — International Olympic Committee

The main organisation of the Olympic Movement. It promotes the Olympic values and oversees the Olympic Games.

NOC — National Olympic Committee

Represents the Olympic Movement in a particular country and supports participation of that country's athletes and sports organisations in the Olympics. **India's NOC is the Indian Olympic Association (IOA).**

IFs — International Federations

International organisations responsible for particular sports. They develop and maintain rules and help govern their sport internationally.

Other Members

- Athletes
- Organising Committees for Olympic Games (OCOGs)
- Other recognised organisations and participants connected with the Olympic Movement

■ **Remember:** IOC = International level Olympic body | NOC = Country level | IF = Particular sport

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS — EXAM PRACTICE

Use these for self-testing after revising the chapter.

1. What is Olympism? Explain its main idea.
2. Write the three main Olympic values and explain each one.
3. What is Olympic Value Education?
4. Explain: Joy of Effort, Fair Play, Respect for Others, Pursuit of Excellence.
5. What is meant by balance among Body, Will and Mind?
6. Differentiate between Ancient Olympics and Modern Olympics.
7. Where and when were the first modern Olympic Games held?
8. Who played a major role in reviving the modern Olympic Games?
9. Write a short note on the Olympic Rings.
10. What is the Olympic Motto? Write its meaning.
11. Write short notes on the Olympic Flag, Olympic Oath and Olympic Anthem.
12. What is the structure of the Olympic Movement? Explain IOC, NOC and IFs.
13. What is the role of the IOC?
14. What is an NOC? Name India's NOC.
15. What are International Federations (IFs) and what do they do?

■ LAST 5-MINUTE REVISION

E-F-R → Excellence, Friendship, Respect

1896 → **Athens** | **Pierre de Coubertin** → revival of modern Olympics

Olympia → **Zeus** → Ancient Olympics

Rings → **5 interlocking rings** | **Motto** → **Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together**

IOC → **Olympic Movement** | **NOC** → **Country** | **IF** → **Sport**